

Furman University Equestrian Team Constitution
Updated September 20th, 2022

Article 1. Name

Article 1.1. The formal name of this organization shall be Furman University Equestrian Team (FUET).

Article 2. Purpose

Article 2.1. The purpose of FUET shall be to ride horses.

Article 3. Affiliations

Article 3.1. FUET is affiliated with the Club Sports organization under the Student Government Association. FUET is also affiliated with the Intercollegiate Horse Show Association (IHSA) through which we compete against other affiliated schools.

Article 4. Membership

Article 4.1. Any Furman University student can join the club. In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation. There will be tryouts held at the beginning of each semester for the show team which competes in IHSA competitions.

Article 4.2. Meetings

Article 4.2.1. Meetings will be required for either the show team or the entire club as specified by officers.

Article 4.2.2. Excuses: If a member is unable to attend a meeting, they must notify the President or Vice President at least 24 hours in advance with a valid excuse for it to be considered excused. Late excuses will be considered unexcused. The officers, on a case-by-case basis, will determine what constitutes acceptable excuses.

Article 4.2.3. Excessive absences (excused or not) may lead to dismissal from the show team or club team.

Article 4.2.4. The Public Image Representative is expected to create an infographic of the important topics from the meeting to all relevant team members, including members who were absent. The information to be included shall be supplied by the Vice President, and the Vice President shall distribute the infographic.

Article 4.3. Team Member Behavior Expectations

Article 4.3.1. Lesson Attendance: All FUET riders, show team or club team, are expected to attend their scheduled lessons. If they are unable to attend, they must send no less than 24 hours of notice to both coaches and the President in a group chat.

Article 4.3.2. Meeting Attendance: All FUET riders are expected to attend all meetings, unless their presence is specifically released. The President or Vice President is responsible for designating who is expected to attend each meeting.

Article 4.3.3. Communication: All team members are expected to provide clear communication with each other regardless of position. Team members who fail to respond to communication attempts can expect to lose privileges (such as removal from the show team) or dismissal from the team entirely, at the discretion of the President.

Article 5. Officer Expectations and Descriptions

Article 5.1. Requirements for officer positions

Article 5.1.1. In order to be eligible to hold an executive officer position, a team member must have had at least one year's experience on the show team. It is not required for President to have held an officer position prior, however it is strongly encouraged.

Article 5.1.2. In order to be eligible to hold a representative officer position, a team member must have had at least one year's experience on either the club team or show team.

Article 5.1.3. This member must be in good standing with the team regarding meeting and lesson attendance, team participation, relationship with coaches, and dues/fees. In addition to the regular team meetings, they must be willing to attend any officers meetings (times to be determined by officers).

Article 5.1.4. All potential officers or representatives must be on campus for the full length of their term.

Article 5.1.5. Any officer who is removed from their position will be ineligible for re-election or election into any other position for the duration of their time at Furman University.

Article 5.1.6. President will be the only officer that is guaranteed a spot at shows in order to ensure an officer is present. President will only be guaranteed one show class if he/she is eligible for more than one.

Article 5.2. Executive Officer Descriptions

Article 5.2.1. An executive officer is one who has the ability to make choices that directly impact the functioning of the team, as outlined in their descriptions, and are the only officers who have executive authority over team members.

Article 5.2.2. President: Leads officer and regular meetings; organizes paperwork for registration at the beginning of school year; communicates with Leslie and Muffin on a regular basis about team members and lesson progress; handles disputes and problems between members, officers, and trainers; creates and manages lesson schedule at the beginning of each semester; registers for and maintains organization at horse shows; delegates other responsibilities and ensures other officers are doing their duties; attends the draw at shows; attends required club sports meetings; sends weekly team email including updates and schedule; assists in creating budget; is able to request money from Club Sports Director; keeps minutes for each meeting to send out to those absent

Article 5.2.3. Vice President: In charge of involvement fair, open house, and closing house activities; organizes team-bonding activities; plans and acquires senior and trainer gifts; acts in the absence of president at meetings and/or horse shows; reserves rooms for meetings; plans show team dinners; assigns show buddies and hotel rooms; keeps record of lesson and meeting attendance, is responsible for sending a summary of all major topics covered in meetings to the the team groupme;

Article 5.2.4. Treasurer: Creates and manages budget and budget request forms; turns in receipts for reimbursements; requests entry fees for shows and brings checks to show; keeps in communication with Club Sports Director and president to make sure everything financial is done in a timely manner; in charge of collecting and holding show team fees; books hotel rooms for shows; in charge of fundraising;

Article 5.3. Representative Officer Position Descriptions

Article 5.3.1. A representative officer is one who has a designated responsibility to perform specified duties, but has no ultimate control over decisions made by the executive council, although they may be asked to provide input on relevant topics.

Article 5.3.2. Freshmen Class Representative: Is in attendance for officer meetings, does not have the ability to vote on executive decisions but is responsible for representing the interests of the freshman class.

Article 5.3.3. Public Image Representative: Keeps all social media accounts up to date (including but not limited to SyncDin, Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Snapchat, and Website); makes flyers and informational pamphlets; organizes yearly photo-shoot; posts meeting and important information on SyncDin; improves team's relationship with the greater Greenville community; promotes team unity within IHSA; writes thank you notes for host schools after shows.

Article 5.3.4. Apparel Representative: Is responsible for organizing team apparel designs; team apparel order days; and placing team apparel orders, which will be paid for not from FUET funds, but by individual members.

Article 5.4. Officer expectations and removal

Article 5.4.1. Responsibilities may be re-delegated at any officer meeting if agreed upon by the president and relevant officer(s). These duties will be re-set each year, and any changes must be agreed upon the current officers.

Article 5.4.2. If an officer is seen as unfit to do his/her job, the other officers may vote to have him/her step down at any time. If said officer declines to step down, the other officers may vote to remove them, effective immediately. Following this, a nomination and vote to fill the position will be held at the next team meeting.

Article 5.4.3. All officers are expected to conduct themselves in a professional manner and act in the best interests of the FUET team as a whole.

Article 6. Officer Elections

Article 6.1. Executive and Representative Elections (Excluding Freshman Class Representative)

Article 6.1.1. The executive officer positions are: President, Vice President, and Treasurer. They will be referred to as "executive officers" or the "executive council."

Article 6.1.2. The representative officer positions are: Public Image and Apparel. They will be referred to by their

titles.

Article 6.1.3. Executive officer, Public Image, and Apparel elections will be held at the end of the fall semester of each year, ideally December. All executive officer and representative officer nominations can be made by any team member and will be voted on by the full team digitally via a Google Form.

Article 6.1.4. In order to run, a member may either nominate themselves or be nominated by another team member for any position in the executive council, Public Image, or Apparel, excluding the position of president, by notifying the current President. The current President will then confirm with each potential candidate that they are interested in running for that position.

Article 6.1.5. Presidential nominations will happen in a two-step process. Members will alert the current Vice President of their interest in the Presidential office position and then those individuals will go through a slating process. The Vice President and Treasurer will then choose two of these individuals to present to the team as candidates for President, to avoid a conflict of interest should the current President choose to run for re-election.

Article 6.1.6. After slating candidates for all officer positions, the current President will distribute a list of all potential officers, including presidential candidates, to the rest of the team two (2) days prior to releasing the official voting document.

Article 6.1.7. The Team will then vote remotely on the Google Form, which will be active for twenty-four (24) hours.

Article 6.1.8. No less than three-fourths majority participation is required for the voting to pass, meaning three-fourths of the team must submit their electronic vote via Google Form. All members are required to vote.

Article 6.1.9. The position will be given to the nominated member who receives a majority of the votes.

Article 6.1.10. Freshman Class Representative Elections

Article 6.1.10.1. Only members of the freshmen class are eligible for Freshman Class Representative (FCR).

Article 6.1.10.2. Elections for FCR should be held in August or September of the fall semester.

Article 6.1.10.3. An FCR may be nominated by anyone on the team.

Article 6.1.10.4. After confirming with each potential candidate that they are interested in running for FCR, the President will distribute a list of all potential representatives and the full team will have twenty-four (24) hours to vote remotely via Google Form.

Article 6.1.10.5. The position will be given to the nominated member who receives a majority of the votes.

Article 7. Furman and IHSA Liaisons

Article 7.1. Advisor

Article 7.1.1. The advisor of FUET, Cleve Fraiser, primarily serves to advise decisions made by the FUET council of executives. Dr. Fraiser should be listed as the "Representative" on all IHSA forms.

Article 7.2. School Representative

Article 7.2.1. The school representative for FUET is Ian Brown, the Director of Campus Recreation and Wellness, and he will primarily serve to allocate the team's yearly funding and then to approve all budget requests made throughout the year, assist in registering the FUET show team with IHSA, and advise FUET on decisions made regarding the team.

Article 7.2.2. Ian Brown should be listed as the "Athletic Director" on all IHSA forms.

Article 7.3. School Correspondence

Article 7.3.1. The school representative on all IHSA forms should be designated as the current FUET president.

Article 7.4. Finance

Article 7.4.1. FUET receives funding from the Club Sports organization under the Student Government Association.

Article 7.4.2. In order for any funds to be used from the FUET budget, a formal request must be presented to the executive council (President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Public Relations) and receive a three-fourths majority approval for the designated use of said funds. The treasurer is then responsible for submitting said request to Ian Brown for approval.

Article 7.4.3. Misuse of club funds is grounds for immediate dismissal from the Team, no notice required, should the executive officers achieve a three-fourths majority ruling in favor of

removal.

Article 8. Article IX: Amendments

Article 8.1. To amend the Constitution, there must be a majority vote of at least a three fourths majority of the team.

Article 9. Bylaws of the Furman University Equestrian Team Constitution Article I: Membership

Article 9.1. I. A. Show Team

Article 9.2. Tryouts will be held in the first two weeks of lessons and decisions will be made by the trainer(s). For each show class riders will be ranked at the beginning of the semester in order of trainer preference for shows. Decisions on members showing will be made by trainers within a week of particular show and are completely at the discretion of the

Article 9.3. trainers. An IHSA membership fee (\$40 for each member) is required upon registration each year that you are trying out for the team. All members who pay the membership fee and attend the lessons required to tryout considered for the show team and showing opportunities. To maintain membership once joined, a person must have at least 4 lessons a month with the trainer(s) at the team barn. Exceptions will be made on a case-by-case basis decided on by the officers. In order to show, a member must have made up all missed lessons and attend the meeting prior to the show, unless excused. Show team members will be required to pay fees for shows or show team required apparel as specified by the officers. All show team members will sign a contract at the beginning of the season agreeing to the terms of the team.

Article 9.4. I. B. Dismissal from the team

Article 9.5. A member will be dismissed from the show team if the trainer(s) and/or the officers determine that the member has excessive and inexcusable absences from lessons and/or meetings, if they show intolerable and unsportsmanlike conduct, or irresponsible and dangerous behaviors at any team-related activity or location (the barn, hotel or traveling for shows, etc.). If a member is dismissed from the show team, they will not be allowed to compete through the end of the season but may still practice and participate in the club. A member will be dismissed from the club entirely if the trainer(s) or the officers determine that the member has engaged in something inappropriate, dangerous, or unsportsmanlike that cannot be overlooked and negatively impacts the team, such as multiple offenses of the above. All members are encouraged to bring to the officer's attention any experience where another member has committed one of the above offenses. All dismissals will be voted on in a confidential meeting with all officers and trainers with a majority ruling. The member in consideration will be notified and given the opportunity to defend his/her situation. If a member is dismissed from the team entirely, they will not be allowed to join the team again at any point in the future nor would they be allowed to continue lessons/boarding at the barn at which the team practices.

Article 10. Article II. Lessons

Article 11. Each member will be put into a weekly group lesson at the beginning of each semester. Lesson groups will be based on class schedule and skill level. Lessons cost \$40 due at the time of the lesson. All members are required to sign into their lessons in the designated sign in book when they attend. It is expected that members inform the trainers no less than 12 hours in advance if they will miss their lesson. If a member misses their lesson without informing the trainer(s) within two hours of the lesson's time, they will be expected to pay for that lesson in full. Missed lessons can be made up in another group lesson or in a private lesson. The member is responsible for contacting the trainer(s) to set up a time to make up their lesson. However, excessive absences (excused or not) may lead to dismissal from the show team.

Article 12. Article III. Shows

Article 13. The president and one other officer will be present in the draw at each show. There is to be no alcohol or other illegal substances consumed from the time the team leaves for a show to the time the team returns to campus. Members competing at shows must travel to shows at the time specified for that show by the officers. Members may not leave from shows unless in special circumstances as decided on by officers and trainers. Members should attend all team events during shows as well as stay with the team in the case of an overnight show. Appropriate show clothes, defined in the IHSA rulebook, should be worn when showing. Show team should sport team apparel at shows when not showing. Good sportsmanlike conduct, as well as support of specified show buddy, is

expected.

Article 14. Article IV. Selecting a barn

Article 15. The officers may choose to relocate barns by a unanimous vote in an officer's meeting. They will then select possible barns in the area to be considered. Location, trainer(s) qualifications, facilities, and cost will be taken into consideration. The president and at least one other officer should schedule a time to meet with the trainer(s) and tour each barn in a timely manner. They will report back to the officers their opinions of each. At the next team meeting, the team will vote which barn to attend after hearing the officer's descriptions and an in-depth conversation about each. Three-fourths majority attendance is required for voting. The barn with the majority of votes will be chosen as the team's new barn.

Article 16. Article V: Selection of Advisor

Article 17. As a club sport, FUET's advisor will be whoever is in charge of the Club Sports organization at the time.

Article 18. Article VI: Rules of Order

Article 19. Internal conflicts will be resolved by the President when possible. If an agreement cannot be reached in this manner, the conflict will be taken to our advisor.

Article 20. Article VII: Amendments

Article 21. The Bylaws can be amended by a majority vote of the Officer Council.